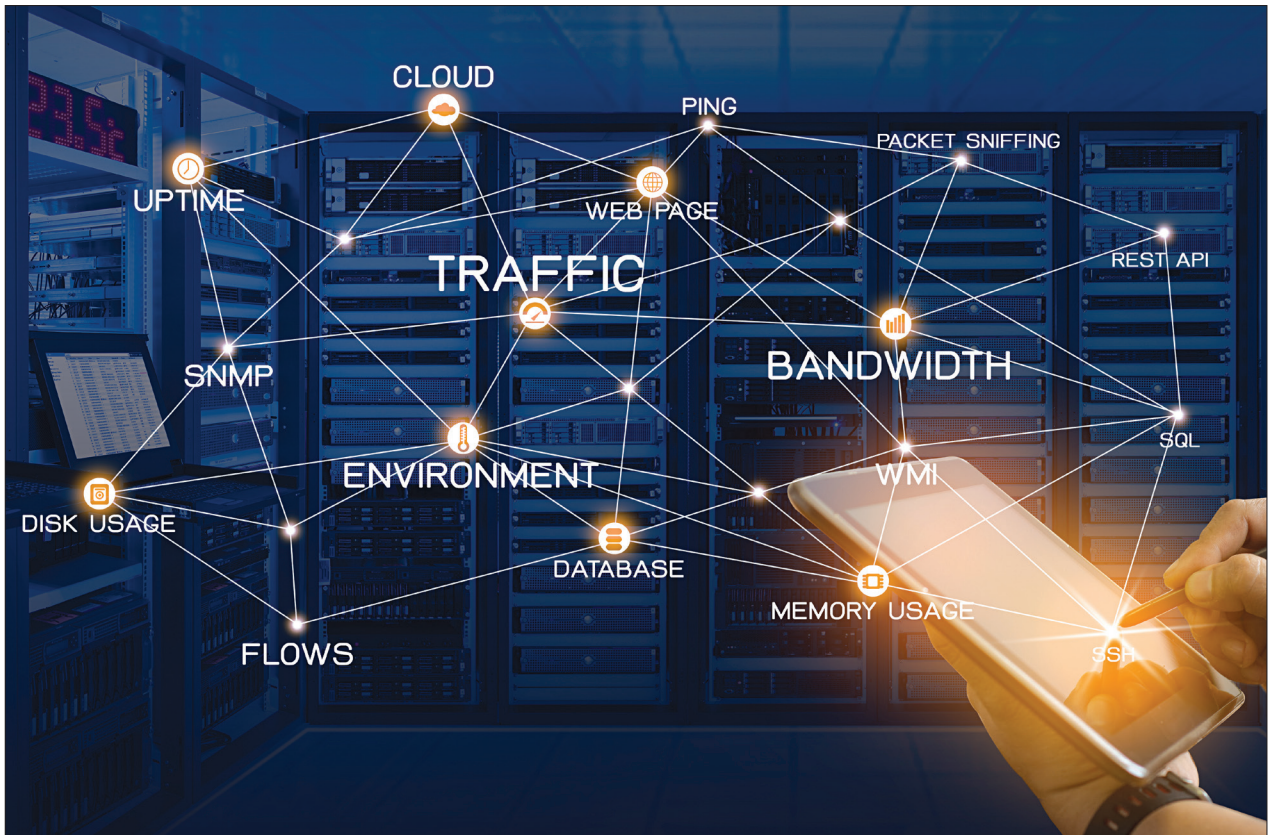




Monitor, maintain & future-proof

Keep networks healthy, today and tomorrow

Even the best-segmented networks will crumble without constant visibility and disciplined upkeep. That's why this chapter walks startups and small offices through (1) choosing and deploying a free Network-Monitoring System (NMS) that fits both shoestring and scale-up budgets, (2) building a rock-solid baseline so alerts fire only when business is at risk, (3) tracing Wi-Fi, DNS and cabling gremlins in minutes – not hours, (4) automating patch, backup and gold-image recovery to slash recovery time, and (5) sizing up Wi-Fi 7, IPv6 and light-weight SD-WAN so your next upgrade lands on target.

Each section emphasizes open-source or zero-cost tiers, cites India-specific regulations where they apply, and ends with a checklist you can pin on the rack.

Choosing an open-source NMS: Zabbix, Prometheus, LibreNMS

Why Open Source?

A paid SaaS monitor can cost ₹1,000–2,500 per node per year, and it's not unlikely for an MSME with 60 devices to spend more on monitoring than on switches. Self-hosted open-source platforms avoid that bill, scale linearly, and let data stay on-prem – handy after CERT-In's 180-day log-retention mandate in India.

Decision Matrix (Concertium Criteria)

Concertium rates NMS tools on four pillars: Discovery, Alerting,